

Jargon buster

Access Point: It is a piece of hardware which connects wireless adapters to a wired LAN. For home and SoHo (Small office Home office) networks it is connected to the LAN card on a PC, using a cross over cable.

Wireless Adapter: It is the wireless replacement for the network interface (LAN) card—available in the PCI and PCMCIA interface.

DHCP: Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol allows the adapters to automatically pick up IP addresses from the list defined in the DHCP configuration on the Access Point.

SSID: Service Set Identifier is a 32-character unique identifier attached to the header of packet transmitted over wireless LAN. SSID differentiates one WLAN from another, so that all access points and devices attempting to connect to a specific WLAN must use the same SSID. It is also referred to as a Network name.

all your wireless hardware from a single vendor to avoid such problems.

Setting up a hybrid LAN is a tad more complicated. Follow the steps below to connect and configure an Access Point to

set up your hybrid LAN:

STEP 1 Connect the Access Point to the existing LAN with a normal RJ45 cable, which costs around Rs 50 for a 5 meter cable.

STEP 2 Power up the Access Point and access the built-in Web server by entering its IP address (for example, <http://192.168.0.1>) in the browser of the master system. This will open a configuration page, from where the rest of the Access Point configuration can be done.

exists a default IP and subnet mask—do not change this. Click on the DHCP tab. Here, enable the DHCP server and assign a starting IP (192.168.0.2) and ending IP (192.168.0.254) address for the client adapter to automatically pick up IPs. Enable DHCP only if you want the client PC to get its IP automatically, otherwise disable the DHCP server and manually assign the IPs for the client PCs.

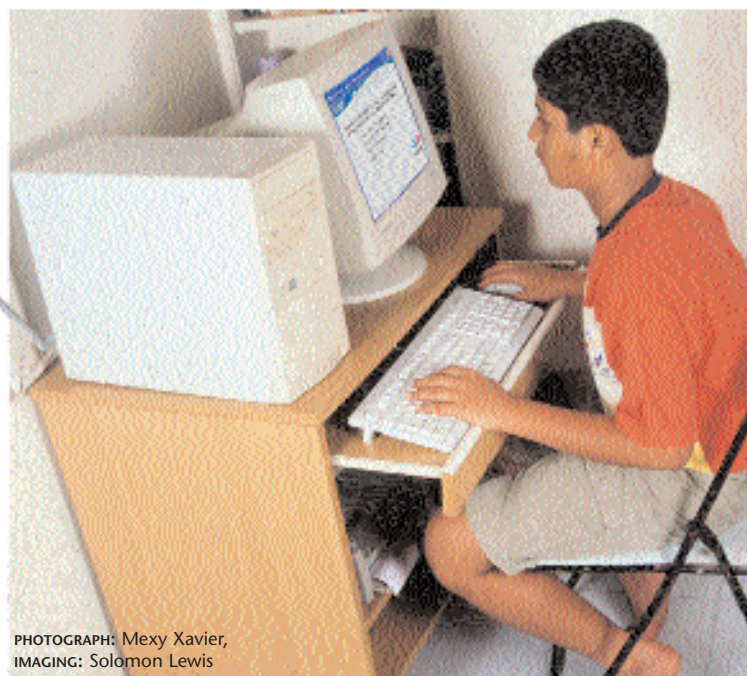
Can you afford the latest? The cost of setting up 5 PCs on a LAN (in Rs)

Component	100 MBps LAN	11 MBps Wireless hybrid LAN
LAN card	2,500	22,500
Access Point	Nil	10,000
Cable	500	Nil
Entry-Level switch	4,000	Nil
Total	7,000	32,500

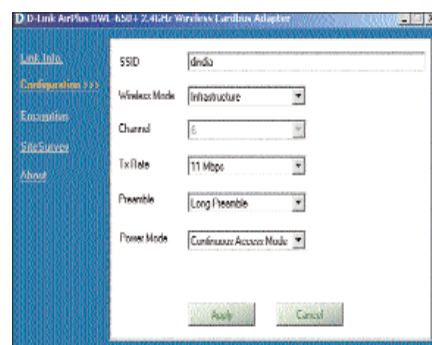
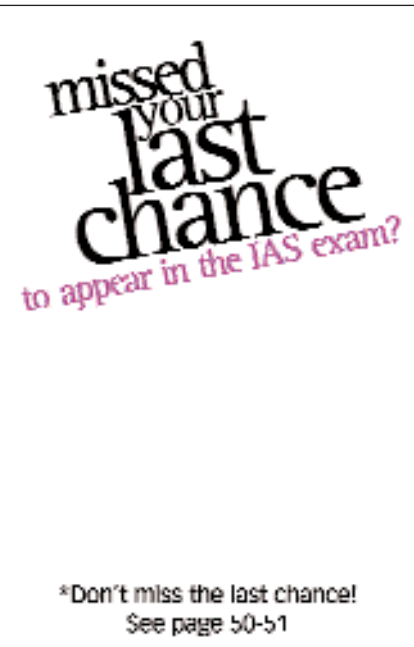


The Setup Wizard makes the configuration of your LAN settings a snap

STEP 3 Click on the Wireless tab. There are default values assigned to various fields. Change the SSID (Service Set Identification) to something else, such as 'home' or 'wireless' and assign a network key. Set it to run in infrastructure mode and set the WEP (Wireless Equivalent Protocol) to 64-bit from the drop down menu. The reason for not using 128 or 256-bit WEP encryption is that higher settings will lower the data throughput because of greater security checks. Under the LAN tab, there



PHOTOGRAPH: Mexy Xavier, IMAGING: Solomon Lewis



Configure the clients using the Wireless Adapter Configuration utility